

Malta's 169% rise in emissions?

A news report of a Eurostat estimate, tested against the data

THE CLAIM

“Malta recorded the highest increase in greenhouse gas emissions among European Union member states”

Newsbook, 18 June 2026, opening line of the article (headline: “Malta records EU’s largest rise...”)

Emissions “rose by an estimated 169.4% between 2015 and 2025”.

Eurostat’s own release gives +169.4%; today’s database +169.7%. The EU fell 17.2%.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*The number is right;
check what it counts.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+169.7%

Eurostat accounts

Malta 2015–2025; next highest Cyprus +10.7%. Only four EU states rose.

98.6%

Air transport

Share of the 2015–2024 increase from air transport attributed to Malta.

+2.9%

Everything else

Malta without air transport, 2015–2024 (electricity –16.5%).

+1.6%

National inventory

UNFCCC territorial total 2015–2024; 27% below 2005.

Residence

Why they differ

Accounts count resident operators wherever they fly; the inventory counts emissions in Malta.

FAIR TO SAY

Newsbook’s text explains the aviation difference; its headline alone does not. Neither measure is wrong.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The Central Bank of Malta report.

☐ A national estimate of aviation emissions to and from Malta.

☐ Eurostat’s 2025 activity breakdown.

☐ Which operators drive the total (not assessed).